

EMMANUEL DARKWA

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SUMMARY

Product and project professional with hands-on data and AI experience. I run discovery, translate business questions into requirements engineers can build against, and stay close enough to the technical work to size it honestly. Experience spans analytics, LLM-powered product prototypes, and coordinating cross-functional teams through Agile delivery. SAFe® POPM certified.

SKILLS

Product & Project: Agile, Scrum, Kanban, Jira, Confluence, backlog prioritization, requirements gathering, roadmapping, KPI definition, stakeholder management, SAFe® POPM

Data & Analytics: Python, SQL, pandas, Power BI, DAX, ETL, REST APIs, OAuth 2.0, data modeling, dashboarding

AI & Engineering: LLM integration, prompt engineering, predictive modeling, TypeScript, Next.js, React, Git/GitHub, Docker

EXPERIENCE

University of Illinois — Division of Intercollegiate Athletics

Data Analyst | Oct 2025 – Present

- Partner with leadership and stakeholders to define KPIs and translate business questions into technical requirements, then build and maintain the reporting that answers them.
- Build Power BI dashboards backed by Python and SQL, making large volumes of operational data digestible for non-technical decision makers.
- Developed automated data pipelines integrating REST API (OAuth 2.0) and FTP sources, replacing a manual multi-step extraction process and filtering a national dataset from ~11,000 files to the 110 relevant records.
- Work across data analysis, data engineering, and applied modeling; operate in a team Git workflow using feature branches and pull requests.

Health Analytics Society, University of Illinois

Technical Project Manager | 2025 – 2026

- Led project delivery for a stroke prediction model and a disease outbreak simulation, coordinating engineers, health domain personnel, and organization leadership from scoping through delivery.
- Introduced and ran a **Kanban** workflow on **GitHub**, with **Jira** and **Confluence** used for ticket tracking and documentation.
- Served as the primary translator between clinical and data contributors, defining what health markers the models needed and what the data team required to deliver them.

NASA Space Apps Challenge — Chicago

Backend Engineer | Oct 2025

- Designed backend architecture and built API endpoints, data pipelines, and AI-powered insight modules for an urban planning tool analyzing population density, air quality, income, and weather data across Chicago.

Publicis Sapient

Product Management Intern | Jun 2025 – Aug 2025

- Integrated large language models into product prototypes for enterprise clients, shaping how AI features delivered value to end users.
- Coordinated engineers, designers, and stakeholders through Agile sprint cycles to deliver working prototypes on compressed timelines.
- Presented product strategy and roadmap to senior leadership; earned SAFe® POPM certification during the program.

University of Illinois — Division of Intercollegiate Athletics

IT Support Specialist | Aug 2023 – Jul 2026

- Resolved high-volume help desk tickets via Zendesk across Windows, macOS, and Linux; administered Active Directory accounts and wrote automation scripts to reduce repetitive work.

PROJECTS

- **Basketball Personnel Reporting Tool** (Next.js, TypeScript, Recharts) — scoped and built a full-stack analytics dashboard across four leagues, including an era-adjusted team strength model with recency decay and a valuation model for 1,000+ players.
- **PhishNet AI** — phishing detection engine scoring messages for fraud risk with plain-language reasoning behind each classification, designed for non-technical users.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

B.S. in Information Sciences, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign — Minors in Computer Science, Health Technology, and Cybersecurity

Certifications: SAFe® POPM (Product Owner / Product Manager) • CompTIA A+ • CompTIA Security+ (in progress) • AWS Cloud Practitioner (in progress)